

ශ්‍රී ලංකා විභාග දෙපාර්තමේන්තුව ශ්‍රී ලංකා විභාග දෙපාර්තමේන්තුව ශ්‍රී ලංකා විභාග දෙපාර්තමේන්තුව ශ්‍රී ලංකා විභාග දෙපාර්තමේන්තුව
 இலங்கைப் பரீட்சைத் திணைக்களம் இலங்கைப் பரීட்சைத் திணைக்களம் இலங்கைப் பரීட்சைத் திணைக்களம் இலங்கைப் பரීட்சைத் திணைக்களம்
 Department of Examinations, Sri Lanka Department of Examinations, Sri Lanka Department of Examinations, Sri Lanka Department of Examinations, Sri Lanka

අධ්‍යයන පොදු සහතික පත්‍ර (උසස් පෙළ) විභාගය, 2023(2024)
 கல்விப் பொதுத் தராதரப் பத்திர (உயர் தர)ப் பரீட்சை, 2023(2024)
 General Certificate of Education (Adv. Level) Examination, 2023(2024)

ඉංග්‍රීසි I
 ஆங்கிலம் I
 English I

73 E I

පැය තුනයි
 மூன்று மணித்தியாலம்
 Three hours

අමතර කියවීමේ කාලය - මිනිත්තු 10 යි
 மேலதிக வாசிப்பு நேரம் - 10 நிமிடங்கள்
 Additional Reading Time - 10 minutes

Use the **additional reading time** to go through the question paper, select the questions you will answer, and decide which of them you will prioritise. English Literature Sri Lanka

Instructions:

- * Answer all the questions in Part A and Part B.
- * The texts you choose to answer questions from Part A must not be the same as those you answer from Part B.
- * Write the number and letter of each question clearly.

Part A

[This part carries 32 marks. Each question carries 08 marks.]

1. Comment briefly on any one of the following passages, explaining its significance to the play from which it is taken.

(a) You make it seem like we were setting a trap.

All pretty girls are a trap, a pretty trap, and men expect them to be.

Now look at yourself, young lady. This is the prettiest you will ever be! I've got to fix myself now! You're going to be surprised by your mother's appearance!

(b) These three have robbed me, and this demi-devil

(For he's a bastard one) had plotted with them

To take my life. Two of these fellows you

Must know and own; this thing of darkness I

Acknowledge mine.

(c) You must understand one thing. We own nothing except ourselves. This world and its laws, allows us nothing, except ourselves. There is nothing we can leave behind when we die, except the memory of ourselves.

(d) And for I know thou'rt full of love and honesty

And weigh'st thy words before thou giv'st them breath,

Therefore these stops of thine fright me the more.

For such things in a false, disloyal knave

Are tricks of custom; but in a man that's just

They're close dilations working from the heart,

That passion cannot rule.

(e) (Speaking with great deference.) Good evening. I'm sorry to bother you, but we just thought we'd better let you know that we haven't got anything left. We sent up all we had. There's no more food down here.



[see page two]

2. Comment briefly on any one of the following passages, explaining its significance to the novel from which it is taken.

- (a) We live by our labours from one harvest to the next, there is no certain telling whether we shall be able to feed ourselves and our children, and if bad times are prolonged we know we must see the weak surrender their lives and this fact, too, is within our experience. In our lives there is no margin for misfortune.
- (b) Who would doubt at that moment that I had indeed come as close to the great hub of things ... ? I would suppose, then, that as I stood there pondering the events of the evening – those that had unfolded and those still in the process of doing so – they appeared to me a sort of summary of all that I had come to achieve thus far in my life. I can see few other explanations for that sense of triumph I came to be uplifted by that night.
- (c) The world isn't just the way it is. It is how we understand it, no? And in understanding something, we bring something to it, no? Doesn't that make life a story?
- (d) Are you afraid – Her gaze sprang with laughing tears as if her own venom had been spat at her; he and she were amazed at her, at this aspect of her, appearing again as the presumptuous stranger in their long acquaintance. Are you afraid I'm going to tell her something? Giddied, he gave up a moment's purchase of ground. What you can tell? His anger struck him in the eyes.
- (e) Just a sense of what might have been with me! My life looks as if it had been wasted for want of chances! When I see what you know, what you have read, and seen, and thought, I feel what a nothing I am! I'm like the poor Queen of Sheba who lived in the Bible. There is no more spirit in me.

3. Comment briefly on the following passage, explaining its significance to the short story from which it is taken.

You said no the following four days to going out with him, because you were uncomfortable with the way he looked at your face, that intense, consuming way he looked at your face that made you say goodbye to him but also made you reluctant to walk away. And then, the fifth night, you panicked when he was not standing at the door after your shift. You prayed for the first time in a long time and when he came up behind you and said hey, you said yes, you would go out with him, even before he asked. You were scared he would not ask again.

4. Comment briefly on the following extract, explaining its significance to the poem from which it is taken. English Literature Sri Lanka

Don't write in English, they said, English is
Not your mother-tongue. Why not leave
Me alone, critics, friends, visiting cousins,
Every one of you? Why not let me speak in
Any language I like? The language I speak,
Becomes mine, its distortions, its queernesses
All mine, mine alone.
It is half English, half Indian, funny perhaps, but it is honest



[see page three]

Part B

[This part carries 68 marks. Each question carries 17 marks.]

5. Drama

Answer any **one** of the following questions. Do **not** answer the question which is based on the text you selected in question 1 of Part A above.

- (a) "The central conflict of the play . . . is neither between white and black alone, nor merely between men and women – the conflict is about a black man and a white woman." Discuss Shakespeare's play *Othello* in relation to this claim.
- (b) "In the final analysis, *The Glass Menagerie* is all about individuals' failure to fulfil their responsibilities to their families, their society and, most importantly, to themselves." Critically examine Tennessee Williams' play *The Glass Menagerie* in light of this statement.
- (c) "Prospero and Caliban can not only exchange places as hero and villain, but also vie with each other to occupy both places at once", because *The Tempest* permits "radically different interpretation, characteristics and emphases". Comment on this analysis of Shakespeare's play *The Tempest*.
- (d) "Identity is both performed, hence flexible, and conferred at birth, hence fixed." Critically explore Athol Fugard et al's *Sizwe Bansi is Dead* with specific reference to this statement.
- (e) Write a critical introduction to Harold Pinter's play *The Dumb Waiter*, focusing on socio-political themes that resonate for a contemporary audience. English Literature Sri Lanka

6. Novel

Answer any **one** of the following questions. Do **not** answer the question which is based on the text you selected in question 2 of Part A above.

- (a) "Ishiguro's *The Remains of the Day* is a novel about regret, which, in Stevens' words, comes about mainly because he didn't know that 'small incidents would render whole dreams forever irredeemable.'" Use this insight to explain the nature of regret in Ishiguro's novel.
- (b) "Tess could have had a different fate had she been a wealthy man! Neither her society nor her social conventions would have made a single impact on how her life would have panned out, had her gender and status changed." Do you agree with this statement on Thomas Hardy's *Tess of the d'Urbervilles*?
- (c) "*Life of Pi* is a treatise on the many ways friendship is sustained. It allows you to forgive opportunistic moments in a friendship and to accept and celebrate the altruistic moments that nourish the same relationship." Critically examine Yan Martel's novel *Life of Pi* in relation to this description.
- (d) "*Nectar in a Sieve* is a strong commentary on South Asian poverty, which is a result of not only economic disparity but also of gender inequality and rigidly assigned gender roles." Do you agree? Discuss Kamala Markandaya's novel, *Nectar in a Sieve*, in light of this analysis.
- (e) "In *July's People*, Nadine Gordimer does not imagine a full-fledged post-apartheid South Africa; rather, she merely outlines possibilities for a more equal co-existence between blacks and whites, and in this process she is very conscious of their huge cultural and ideological differences." Examine Gordimer's novel, *July's People*, in relation to this statement.

[see page four]

7. Short Story

- (a) Discuss the impact of **socio-economic class hierarchies** in **three** short stories in your syllabus, focusing specifically on how these hierarchies move the plot forward.

OR

- (b) Examine how **love** is portrayed in **two** short stories in your syllabus, choosing one written by a woman and one written by a man. Identify and analyse the differences, if any, in the representation and treatment of love in these two texts. English Literature Sri Lanka

OR

- (c) Identify the short story that, in your view, provides the best critical analysis of **women's resistance to gender norms**, and write a short introduction to the story, highlighting this aspect. Note that you first need to justify your selection of the story through a brief comparison with the other stories in your syllabus.

8. Poetry

- (a) Examine how poets contrast **urban and rural life and values**, providing detailed examples from **at least three** poems.

OR

- (b) Critically examine how **protest and struggle** are portrayed in **at least three** poems from your syllabus, paying special attention to similarities and differences in their treatment of these themes.

OR

- (c) Critically analyse **one** of the following:

- (i) The descriptions of **beauty**, both natural and human-made, in **at least three** prescribed poems.
- (ii) The treatment of **nostalgia** in **two** poems in your syllabus, choosing one written by a woman and one written by a man.
- (iii) **Any three** poems written by poets from three different countries, which focus on **crisis**, highlighting differences in their treatment of this theme.

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